

behind its growth. The regular updates and robustness of the OS is the reason it is a market leader.

Ubuntu Desktop and Ubuntu Server : Differences

The main difference in Ubuntu Desktop and Ubuntu Server is, as discussed above, the desktop environment. While Ubuntu Desktop includes a GUI, Ubuntu Server does not. That's because it is a headless server. Servers are usually remotely managed using secure shell(SSH). SSH is present by default in Unix-based operating systems, but it can be set up on Windows as well.

Applications

Ubuntu Desktop contains applications well suited for general use. Office productivity suite, web browser and multimedia software are the few applications you'll find on every desktop. Ubuntu Desktop is available in a variety of flavors.

Ubuntu Server also includes several standard packages. Although, these focus mainly on the server requirements. Hence, Ubuntu Server has flavors such as email server, web server and file server. Specific packages include ifenslave and Apache2.

Ubuntu desktop applications are focused on use on the host machine, Ubuntu Server packages concentrate on allowing connectivity with clients as well as security.

Ubuntu Desktop and Ubuntu Server : Similarities

Both Server and Desktop variants use the same kernel unlike a few years back when they both used two separate kernels. So you can expect consistency across both the platforms when it comes to software installation. And linux allows for a wide variety of customisation from the user. So even if you install Ubuntu Desktop and then change your mind, you could very easily download the required packages and get yourself a GUI enabled Ubuntu Server for yourself. There will always be differences between the two but not enough for a not-so-technical and heavy use.

Support

A new LTS (Long Term Support) version is released every two years in April. LTS versions are trusted the most since they are shipped with the most stable and polished versions of applications. There are interim versions